

Curriculum Vitae (short)

George Walkden

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For a longer CV, see <https://walkden.space/cv.pdf>.

Personal Data

Title	Prof. (PhD)
First name	George
Name	Walkden
Current position	Professor of English Linguistics and General Linguistics (since 2017) (W3)
Current institution(s)/site(s), country	Dept. of Linguistics, Universität Konstanz, Germany
Identifiers/ORCID	0000-0001-5950-9686

Qualifications and Career

Stages	Periods and Details
Degree programme	BA Modern & Medieval Languages, 2004–2008, University of Cambridge, United Kingdom MPhil, Linguistics, 2008–2009, University of Cambridge, United Kingdom
Doctorate	24.11.2012, David Willis, Linguistics, University of Cambridge, United Kingdom
Stages of academic/professional career	2012–2017, Lecturer (permanent) in Linguistics & English Language, The University of Manchester, United Kingdom

Activities in the Research System (selection of recent, higher-profile activities)

- Founder and editor of the *Journal of Historical Syntax*, 2011–; Editor-in-Chief since 2017
- Member of the Executive Committee of CRC 1760 ‘Silence, Noise and Signal in Language’ (SiNoSi), <https://www.sfb1760.uni-konstanz.de/>, 2026–
- Member of the Advisory Board (*Beirat*) of the Linguistic Society of Germany (DGfS), 2024–2028
- Recipient of ERC Starting Grant for project “Sociolinguistic Typology and Responsive Features in Syntactic History” (STARFISH), 2020–2025
- Keynote talks at the 23rd International Diachronic Generative Syntax Conference (DiGS), Paris, France (2023) and the 21st International Conference on English Historical Linguistics (ICEHL), Leiden, Netherlands (2021)
- Member of the Advisory Board of Language Science Press, 2023–2025, and of the Board of LingOA, 2021–2025
- Dean of Studies (*Sektionsstudiendekan*) of the Faculty of Humanities, Universität Konstanz, 2021–2023
- Lead organizer, 22nd Diachronic Generative Syntax (DiGS) Conference, Konstanz (online), May 2021
- Member of the Council of the Philological Society, 2014–2017

Supervision of Researchers in Early Career Phases

Supervised Dissertations (last five years):

- Molly Rolf, *On the morphosyntactic shift from case to prepositions*, 2025. Currently: Postdoctoral researcher, Universität Konstanz.
- Raquel Montero Estebanz, *Mood alternations: a synchronic and diachronic study of negated complement clauses*, 2024. Currently: Postdoctoral researcher, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Spain.
- Gemma Hunter McCarley, *The diachrony of subject pronoun expression in Latin American Spanish: a corpus study*, 2024. Currently: Postdoctoral researcher, University of Toronto, Canada.
- Tian Li, *The Grammaticalisation Process of Mandarin Topic Markers*, 2023. Currently: Researcher, Hubei University of Automotive Technology, China.
- Frederik Hartmann, *The dissolution of Germanic unity: towards a new computational model*, 2021. (Awarded the City of Konstanz Dissertation Prize) Currently: Assistant Professor of Computational Linguistics, University of North Texas, United States.

I am currently main supervisor of three further doctoral students. I have also mentored four postdoctoral researchers in my group at Konstanz, including a recipient of a Humboldt Research Fellowship. Between them, these twelve individuals represent ten different nationalities and four continents.

Scientific Results

Category A

- [1] Walkden, George. 2025. Parataxis and hypotaxis in historical corpora. *Language* 101 (4), e343-e368. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1353/lan.2025.a978279>
- [2] Walkden, George, Gemma Hunter McCarley, Raquel Montero Estebanz, Molly Rolf, Sarah Einhaus and Henri Kauhanen. 2023. Sociolinguistic typology meets historical corpus linguistics. *Transactions of the Philological Society*, 121(3), pp. 546–567. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-968X.12275> (OA)
- [3] Hejná, Michaela and George Walkden. 2022. *A History of English*. Language Science Press. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.6560337>
- [4] Breitbarth, Anne and George Walkden. 2019. Complexity as L2-difficulty: implications for syntactic change. *Theoretical Linguistics* 45 (3–4), pp. 183–209. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1515/tl-2019-0012>
- [5] Thoms, Gary and George Walkden. 2019. vP-fronting with and without remnant movement. *Journal of Linguistics* 55 (1), pp. 161–214. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/S002222671800004X>
- [6] Walkden, George. 2019. The many faces of uniformitarianism in linguistics. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 4 (1), 52, pp. 1–17. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5334/gjgl.888> (OA)
- [7] Kauhanen, Henri and George Walkden. 2018. Deriving the Constant Rate Effect. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 36 (2), pp. 483–521. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-017-9380-1> (OA)
- [8] Rusten, Kristian and George Walkden. 2017. Null subjects in Middle English. *English Language and Linguistics* 21 (3), pp. 439–473. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1360674316000204>
- [9] Walkden, George. 2017. Language contact and V3 in Germanic varieties new and old. *Journal of Comparative Germanic Linguistics* 20 (1), pp. 49–81. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10828-017-9084-2> (OA)
- [10] Walkden, George. 2014. *Syntactic Reconstruction and Proto-Germanic*. Oxford Studies in Diachronic and Historical Linguistics. Oxford: Oxford University Press. ISBN: 9780198712299. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1093/acprof:oso/9780198712299.001.0001>

Category B

- [1] Walkden, George. 2015. HeliPaD: the Heliand Parsed Database. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.4395040>